EXPERIMENT 8

Configuring an Insurance Claim Request Management Application with Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in Zoho Creator

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Title

Design and Implementation of an Insurance Claim Request Form Application with User Permissions, Roles, Role Hierarchy and Data Sharing in Zoho Creator.

Aim

To build a claim-tracking application in Zoho Creator using a structured 13-field claim form (Claim_Request_Form) and report (Claim_Request_Report), and to implement granular role-based access control through a three-level role hierarchy and a custom Read Only data-sharing rule.

Objectives

- To design Claim_Request_Form with 13 Basic Fields grouped into four layout panels: Identity, Contact, Incident Details and Claim Details.
- To create Claim_Request_Report and a dashboard showing claim requests, claim settlement ratio and status-wise and claim-type-wise workload.
- To define the role hierarchy Claims Manager → Claims Adjuster → Claims Intake Executive.
- To configure a data-sharing rule from Claims Adjuster to Claims Intake Executive with Read Only access.
- To understand how RBAC separates data ownership from data visibility.

Software / Tools Required

- Zoho Creator (web-based low-code application development platform)
- Insurance Claim Request Management application created in Zoho Creator
- Web browser with an active internet connection
- Zoho account with access to the application in Edit mode

Introduction / Theory

User Management in Zoho Creator

User management decides who can access an application and what each person may see and do within it. Users are added to an application and associated with permission sets (profiles) and roles; together these control access to forms, reports, pages and records. In the Settings area, the User Permissions section groups these controls under three tabs: Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing.

Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

RBAC is an access-control model in which rights are assigned to roles instead of individual users, and users acquire rights through the roles they hold. It simplifies administration, supports the principle of least privilege, improves data security and keeps the access policy consistent and easy to audit. In an insurance setting this is especially important, because claim records contain personal, financial and policy information that must be seen only by authorised staff.

Key Concepts

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Concept	Description
Users	Individuals added to the application who sign in to work with its forms, reports and data.
Permissions	Named permission sets (profiles) defining what a user may do with components. This application lists *Claims_Admin_Access*, *Read* and *Write*.
Roles	Positions in the organisational structure (Claims Manager, Claims Adjuster, Claims Intake Executive) that determine a user's place in the hierarchy and the visibility of records.
Role Hierarchy	A tree in which each role reports to another. A higher role can generally view the records of roles beneath it; the reverse does not apply.
Data Sharing	Share rules that extend record visibility beyond the hierarchy, from one role or user to another, with a defined level of access (Read Only or Read/Write).

Application Specifications

Parameter	Detail
Application Name	Insurance Claim Request Management
Form Name	Claim_Request_Form
Report Name	Claim_Request_Report
Form Architecture	13 Basic Fields in 4 layout panels (Identity, Contact, Incident Details, Claim Details)
Role Hierarchy	Claims Manager → Claims Adjuster → Claims Intake Executive
Custom Sharing Rule	Claims Adjuster → Claims Intake Executive (Read Only)

Form Field Design

Panel	Field Name	Field Type
Identity	Claim ID	Auto Number
Identity	Claimant Name	Single Line
Identity	Policy Number	Single Line
Contact	Phone Number	Phone
Contact	Email Address	Email
Contact	Address	Multi Line
Incident Details	Claim Type	Dropdown (Vehicle, Health, Property, Life, Travel)
Incident Details	Incident Date	Date
Incident Details	Incident Location	Single Line
Incident Details	Incident Description	Multi Line
Claim Details	Claim Amount	Currency

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Panel	Field Name	Field Type
Claim Details	Submission Date	Date
Claim Details	Claim Status	Dropdown (Submitted, Under Review, Approved, Settled)

Procedure

1. Sign in to Zoho Creator. The home page lists the available applications. Locate the **Insurance Claim Request Management** application (Figure 8.1).

[Insert screenshot: Zoho Creator home page showing the application card]

Figure 8.1: Zoho Creator Home – Insurance Claim Request Management Application

2. Open the application to view its dashboard, which contains the **All Claim Requests** report, the *Total Claim Requests* and *Claim Settlement Ratio* tiles and the claim charts (Figure 8.2).

[Insert screenshot: Application dashboard with report, tiles and charts]

Figure 8.2: Insurance Claim Request Management Application – Access Mode

3. Enter Edit mode by selecting **Edit** on the application card (Figure 8.1) or **Edit this application** at the top-right (Figure 8.2).
4. Select the **Settings** tab from the top navigation bar (Design, Workflow, Settings).
5. Under the PERMISSIONS group, select **User Permissions**. The Users page is displayed with the tabs Permissions, Roles and Data Sharing.

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6. Study the **Permissions** tab. Three permission sets are listed: *Claims_Admin_Access*, *Read* and *Write*. An **Add Permission** button is also provided (Figure 8.3).

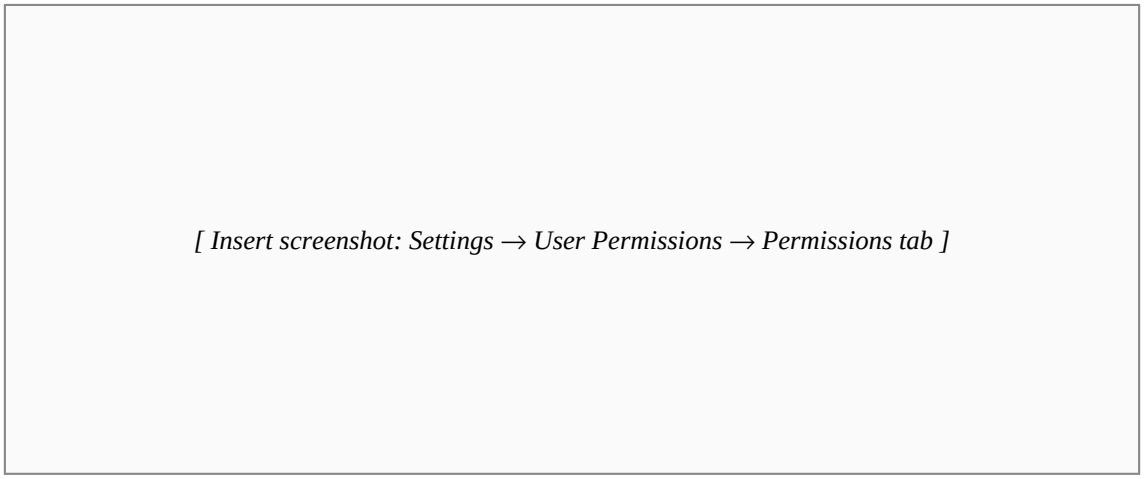

Figure 8.3: User Permissions – Permissions Section

7. Select the **Roles** tab and arrange the role tree as **Claims Manager → Claims Adjuster → Claims Intake Executive**. The Expand All, Collapse All, Manage Role Hierarchy and Add Role options are available (Figure 8.4).

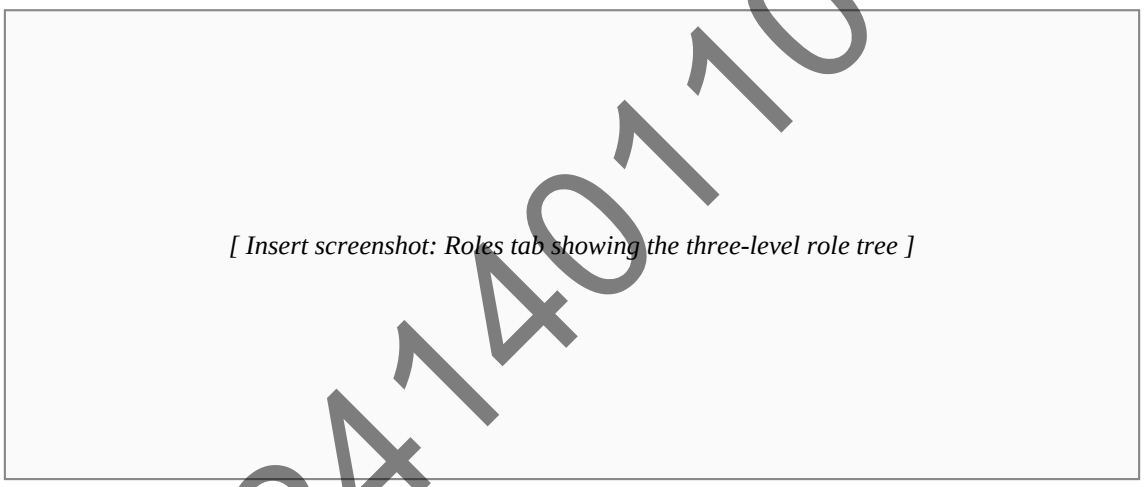

Figure 8.4: Roles and Role Hierarchy

8. Select the **Data Sharing** tab and choose **New Share Rule**. Enter Name: *Claim_Request_Form*; Form: *Claim Request*; Records shared from: *Roles*. The dropdown offers Roles, Roles and Subordinates, and Users (Figure 8.5).

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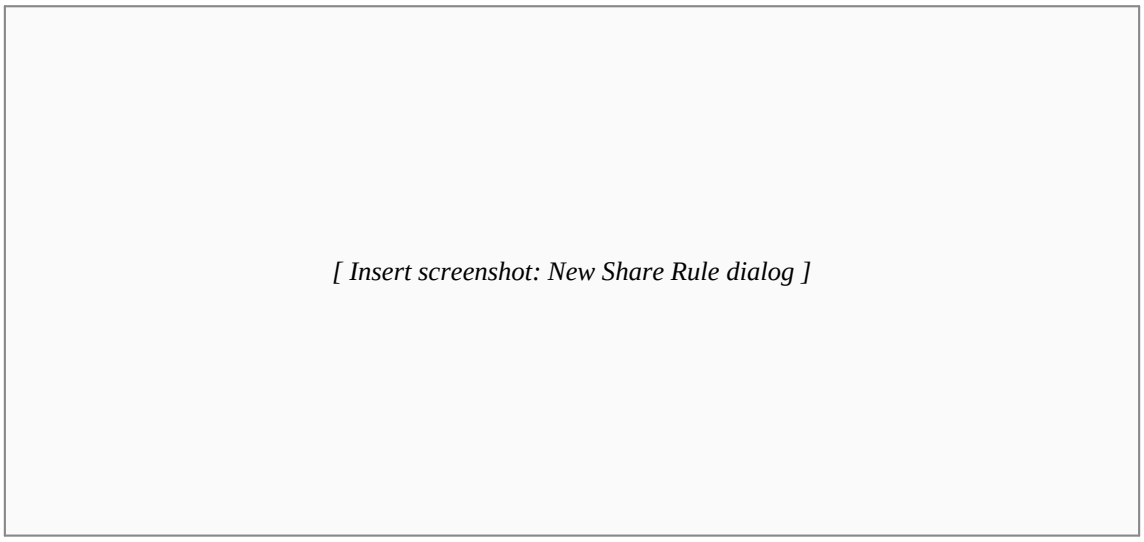

Figure 8.5: New Share Rule – Rule Configuration

9. Set Records shared from → Roles → *Claims Adjuster*; Records shared To → Roles → *Claims Intake Executive*; Level of access → **Read Only**.
10. Select **Save**. The rule appears in the Data Sharing list and can be reopened with Edit Sharing Rule (Figure 8.6).

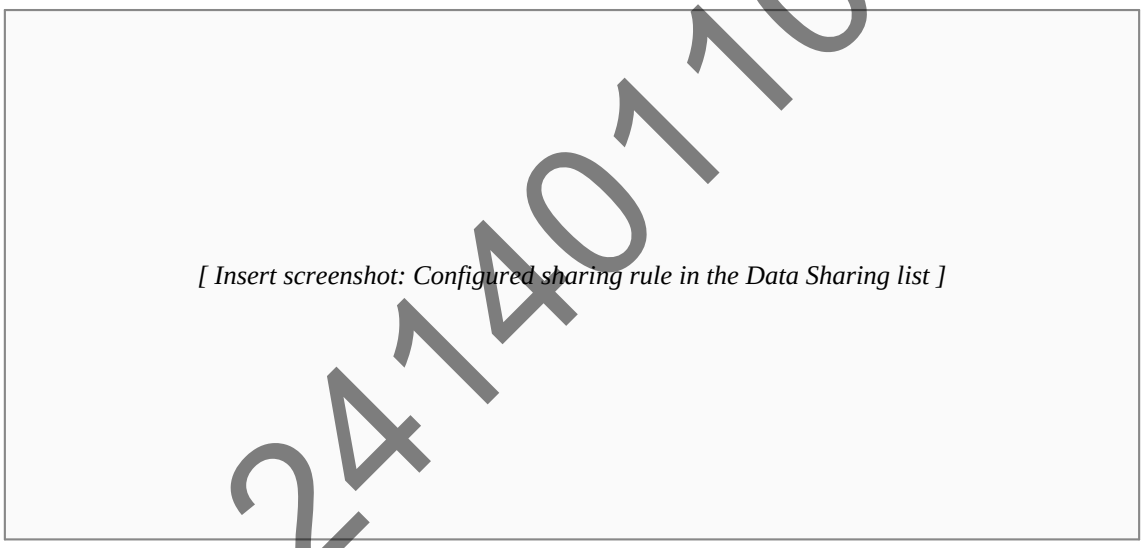

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Figure 8.6: Configured Data Sharing Rule (Claims Adjuster → Claims Intake Executive, Read Only)

Data Sharing

The application follows a layered model: **Form** (Claim_Request_Form) → **Report** (Claim_Request_Report) → **Dashboard** → **Security Layer** (Permissions, Roles, Data Sharing). The role hierarchy runs from the **Claims Manager** (overall oversight) to the **Claims Adjuster** (claim assessment and processing) and then the **Claims Intake Executive** (day-to-day claim intake and registration). By default the hierarchy gives only upward visibility: higher roles see the records of the roles below them, but not the reverse.

The custom data-sharing rule shares Claim_Request_Form records from the *Claims Adjuster* role to the *Claims Intake Executive* role at **Read Only** level. Read Only preserves data security because Claims Intake Executives can view the claim details they need for registration and follow-up (claimant names, policy numbers, claim types, incident dates and contact information) but cannot edit or delete them, so the records held by the Claims Adjuster remain the single source of truth and cannot be altered downstream, whether by accident or deliberately. It enforces least privilege by granting visibility without modification rights, keeps the scope

directional (Adjuster to Executive) so access never flows upward or sideways, and leaves a single named rule in the Data Sharing list that documents who can see what, and at what level, making the policy easy to audit.

RBAC Working

Level	Role	Intended Function
1 (Top)	Claims Manager	Overall authority; able to view the records of roles reporting to it.
2	Claims Adjuster	Assesses and processes claims; owns the master claim request records.
3	Claims Intake Executive	Handles claim intake and registration; views shared claim requests read-only.

- Users in the Claims Intake Executive role work with claim request records according to their permission set.
- Because Claims Intake Executive reports to the Claims Adjuster, who reports to the Claims Manager, higher roles can view the records of the roles below them.
- Lower roles do not automatically gain access to higher-role records; the Read Only share rule grants it in a controlled way.
- The permission sets (Claims_Admin_Access, Read, Write) further limit the operations each user may carry out.

Result

The following were successfully carried out in the Insurance Claim Request Management application:

- The Insurance Claim Request Management application, with Claim_Request_Form and Claim_Request_Report, was opened and its dashboard viewed.
- The permission sets Claims_Admin_Access, Read and Write were studied in User Permissions.
- The role hierarchy Claims Manager → Claims Adjuster → Claims Intake Executive was created.
- A data-sharing rule from Claims Adjuster to Claims Intake Executive with Read Only access was configured and saved.

Conclusion

The experiment demonstrated how permissions, roles, role hierarchy and data sharing together form a role-based access control mechanism in Zoho Creator. Structured claim requests with typed fields replace unstructured requests (paper forms, phone calls and email threads) with clean, consistent and analysable data. The three-level hierarchy and the directional Read Only share rule keep information channels isolated: Claims Intake Executives see only what they need and cannot alter master records, while the Claims Manager and Claims Adjuster retain oversight. The result is a secure, auditable and scalable insurance claim request management framework.

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